

Do minor league giveaways create attendance, or just move it? Triple-A baseball, 2024–2026 · 6,195 home dates · 770 verified giveaways · 30 clubs			
Giveaway lift	Extra fans per giveaway	Giveaways analysed	Club-seasons analysed
9.5	535	577	44

- Giveaways add roughly 9.5% to a Triple-A crowd — about 535 fans on a gate of 5,900.
- The dates around them do not come in below their own baselines, so on three seasons of evidence promotions create attendance rather than move it.
- The single-season version of this analysis found the opposite; that result was a Friday artifact and did not survive.
- See Robustness.

league, club

International League

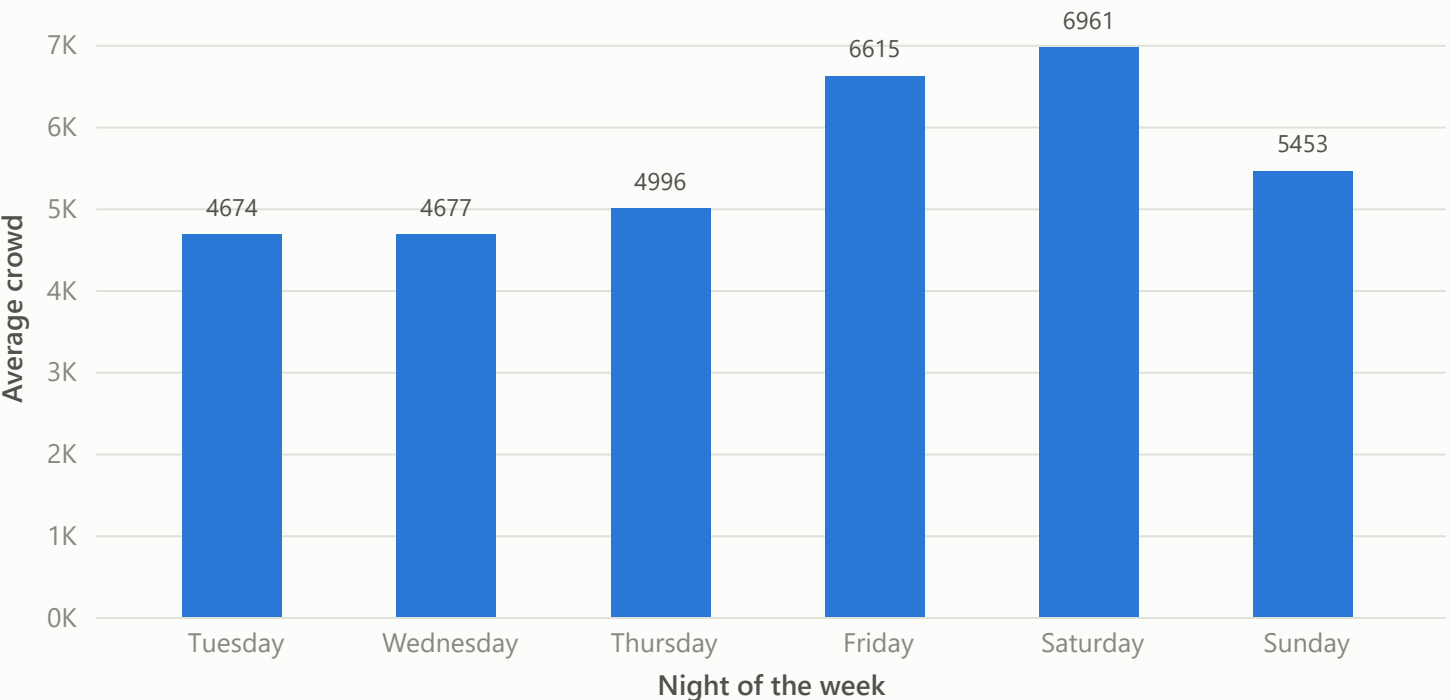
- ☐ Buffalo Bisons
- ☐ Charlotte Knights
- ☐ Columbus Clippers
- ☐ Durham Bulls
- ☐ Gwinnett Stripers
- ☐ Indianapolis Indians
- ☐ Iowa Cubs
- ☐ Jacksonville Jumbo Shrimp
- ☐ Lehigh Valley IronPigs
- ☐ Louisville Bats
- ☐ Memphis Redbirds
- ☐ Nashville Sounds
- ☐ Norfolk Tides
- ☐ Omaha Storm Chasers
- ☐ Rochester Red Wings
- ☐ Scranton/Wilkes-Barre RailRiders
- ☐ St. Paul Saints
- ☐ Syracuse Mets
- ☐ Toledo Mud Hens
- ☐ Worcester Red Sox
- ☐ Pacific Coast League
- ☐ Albuquerque Isotopes
- ☐ El Paso Chihuahuas
- ☐ Las Vegas Aviators
- ☐ Oklahoma City Comets
- ☐ Reno Aces
- ☐ Round Rock Express
- ☐ Sacramento River Cats

What drives attendance before any promotion

Triple-A baseball, 2024–2026 · 6,195 home dates across 30 clubs

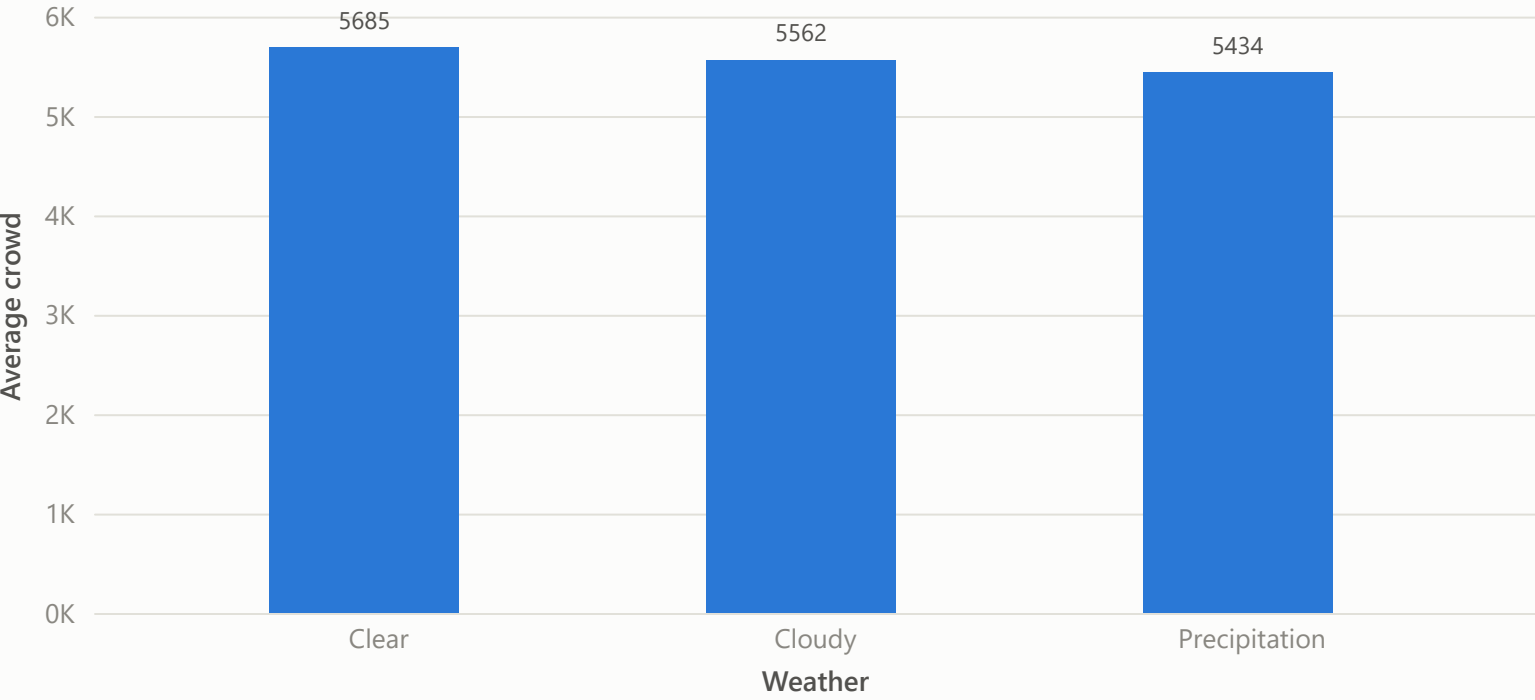
Weekend crowds run a third larger than midweek

Tuesday to Sunday · Monday excluded (25 dates, mostly holidays)



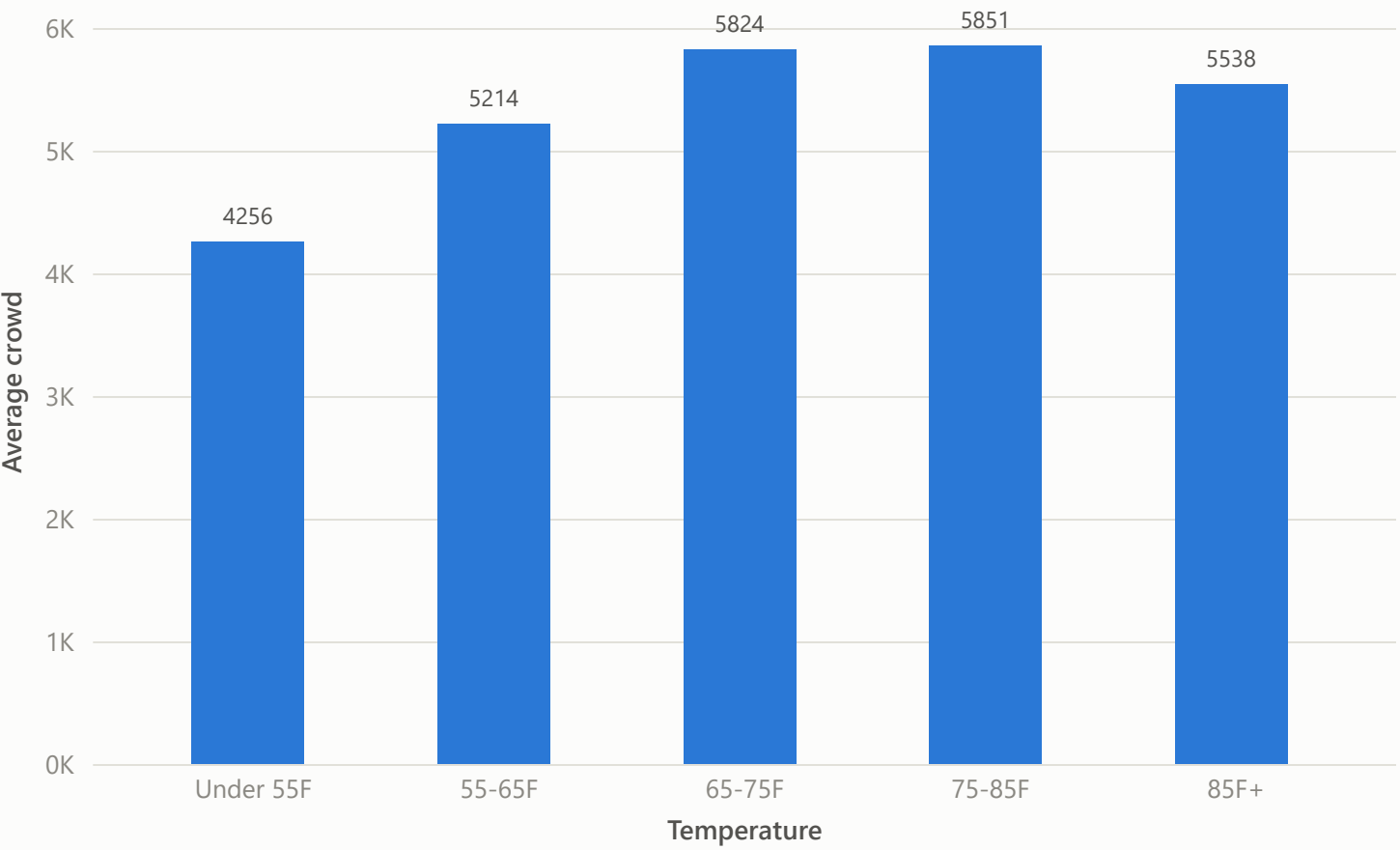
Weather barely moves attendance

Mean crowd by sky conditions at first pitch



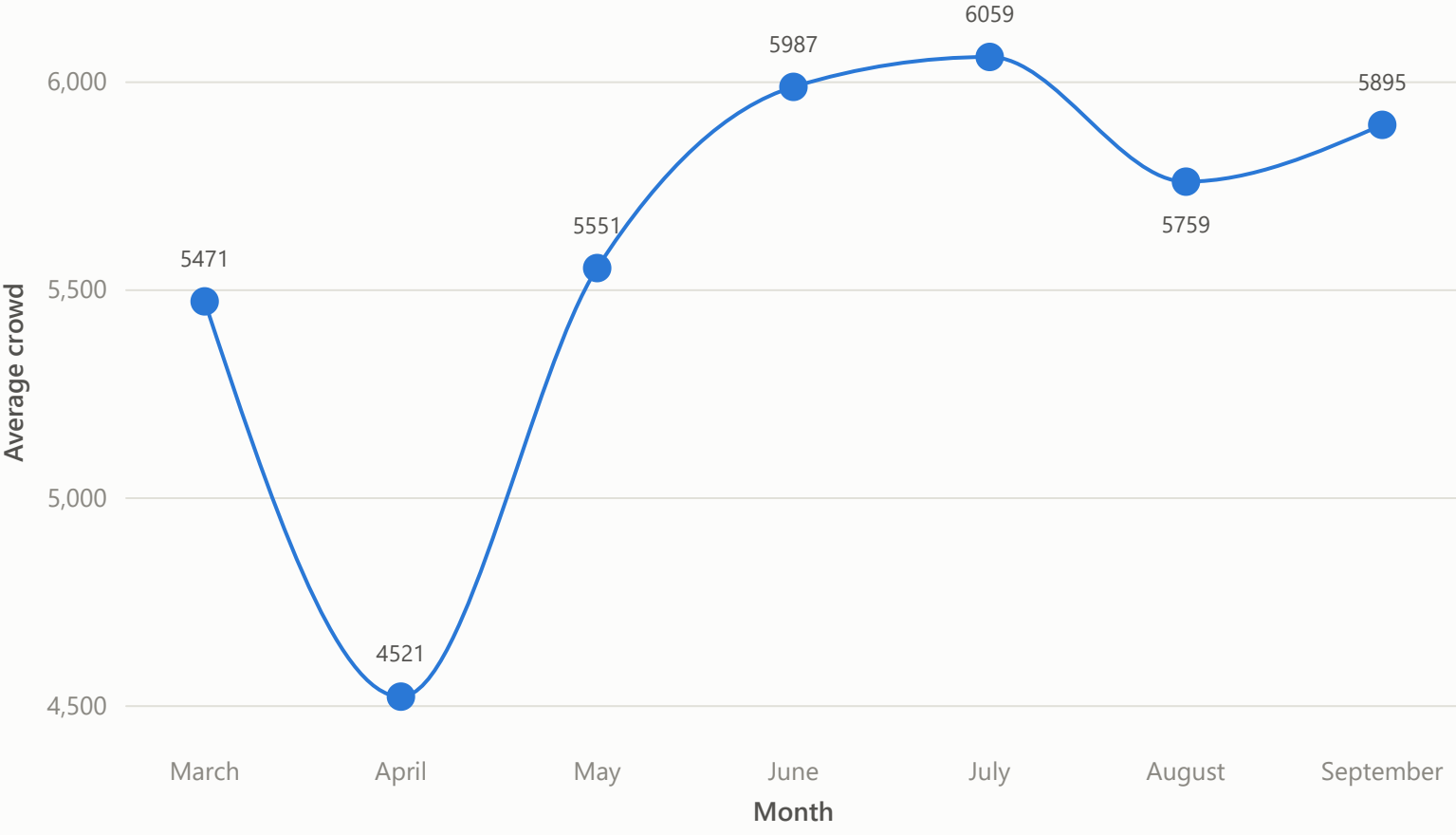
Attendance peaks at 75-85°F and falls off in the heat

Mean crowd by temperature recorded at the ballpark at first pitch



Attendance across the season

Mean crowd by month



Do giveaways actually add anyone?

577 giveaways across 44 club-seasons with complete promotional calendars.

Giveaways analysed

577

Lift on giveaway dates

9.5

Extra fans each

535

Baseline Crowd

5.94K

Giveaway dates draw 9.5% above their own expectation

Actual crowd versus what the model expected, given club, night, month and weather

Effect vs Expected %

10

5

0

9.5

0.4

Giveaway

No giveaway

Effect by night — and where it cannot be trusted

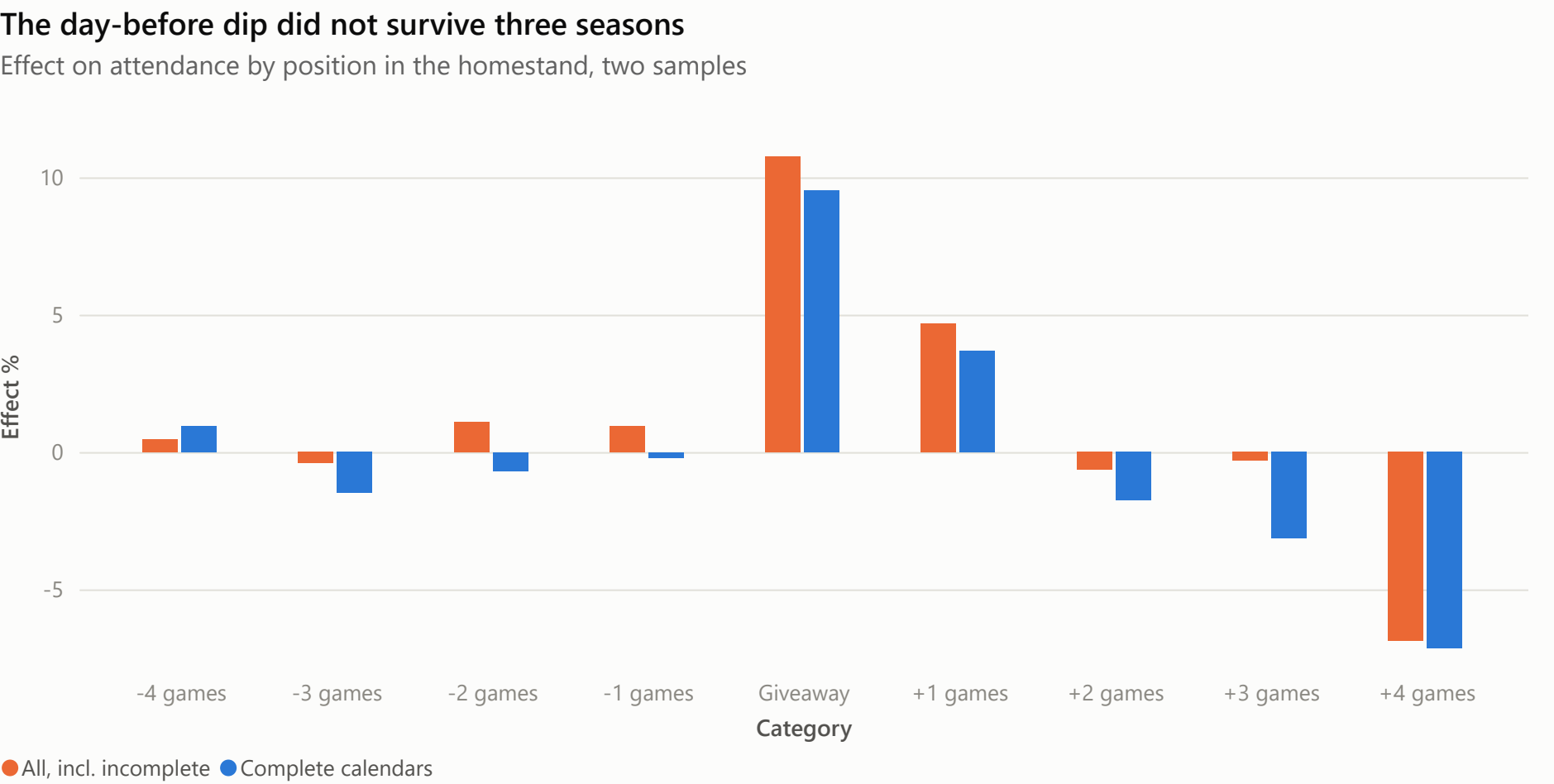
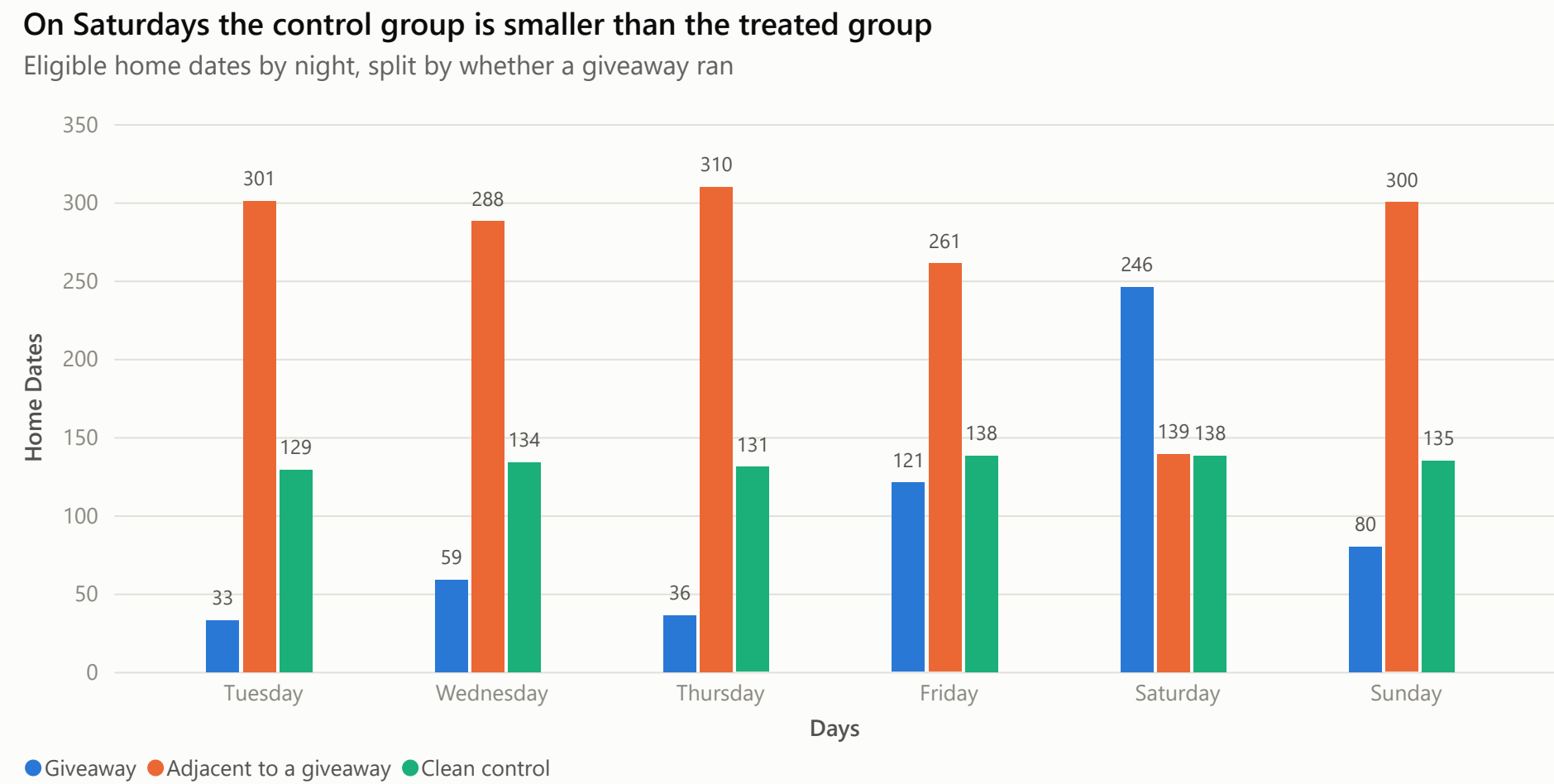
Night	Dates	Effect %	CI low	CI high	Note
Tuesday	33	21.92	9.29	36.01	
Saturday	246	14.70	10.91	18.61	Control pool smaller than treated group - not validated
Friday	121	6.03	-0.10	12.53	
Sunday	80	3.70	-2.80	10.64	
Thursday	36	2.03	-4.95	9.52	
Wednesday	59	0.33	-6.14	7.24	

The findings

- Giveaways add roughly 9.5% to a Triple-A crowd — about 535 fans on a gate of 5,900.
- The estimate is stable across seasons: +10.5% in 2024, +10.3% in 2025, +7.9% in 2026.
- It survives a placebo test decisively: 400 fake giveaway sets matched on weekday produce a mean effect of −0.15%, and not one of the 400 reached the observed +9.5%.
- Saturday remains the one night that cannot be validated — 246 treated dates against 138 clean controls, so the placebo has too small a pool to draw from.

Robustness: what survived and what didn't

The same estimate under two samples, and how three seasons settled the displacement question



Estimates with 95% intervals — shaded rows clear zero

Same model on the 44 eligible club-seasons and on all club-seasons with data

Category	Sample	Effect %	CI Low	CI High	Result n
-4 games	All, incl. incomplete	0.48	-4.60	5.83	140
-3 games	All, incl. incomplete	-0.41	-4.14	3.47	255
-2 games	All, incl. incomplete	1.09	-2.53	4.85	309
-1 games	All, incl. incomplete	0.95	-1.53	3.50	447
Giveaway	All, incl. incomplete	10.75	8.36	13.20	692
+1 games	All, incl. incomplete	4.69	1.75	7.71	457
+2 games	All, incl. incomplete	-0.65	-5.11	4.02	156
+3 games	All, incl. incomplete	-0.31	-8.21	8.27	61
+4 games	All, incl. incomplete	-6.87	-16.42	3.76	33
-4 games	Complete calendars	0.94	-4.64	6.84	116
-3 aames	Complete calendars	-1.48	-5.69	2.92	205

- The giveaway effect holds at +9.5% on the 44 eligible club-seasons, and +10.8% across all club-seasons with data.
- The day before a giveaway runs −0.2% [−3.0, +2.6] — no pull-forward. On one season this same coefficient was −6.6% and looked significant; it was a Friday artifact.
- Intervals that cross zero are indistinguishable from no effect. Only the giveaway date and the day after clear it.

Clubs, and which ones the analysis can use

30 clubs, 2024–2026 · 11 with a complete calendar every season · headline results use the 44 eligible club-seasons

Clubs in the panel

30

Complete every season

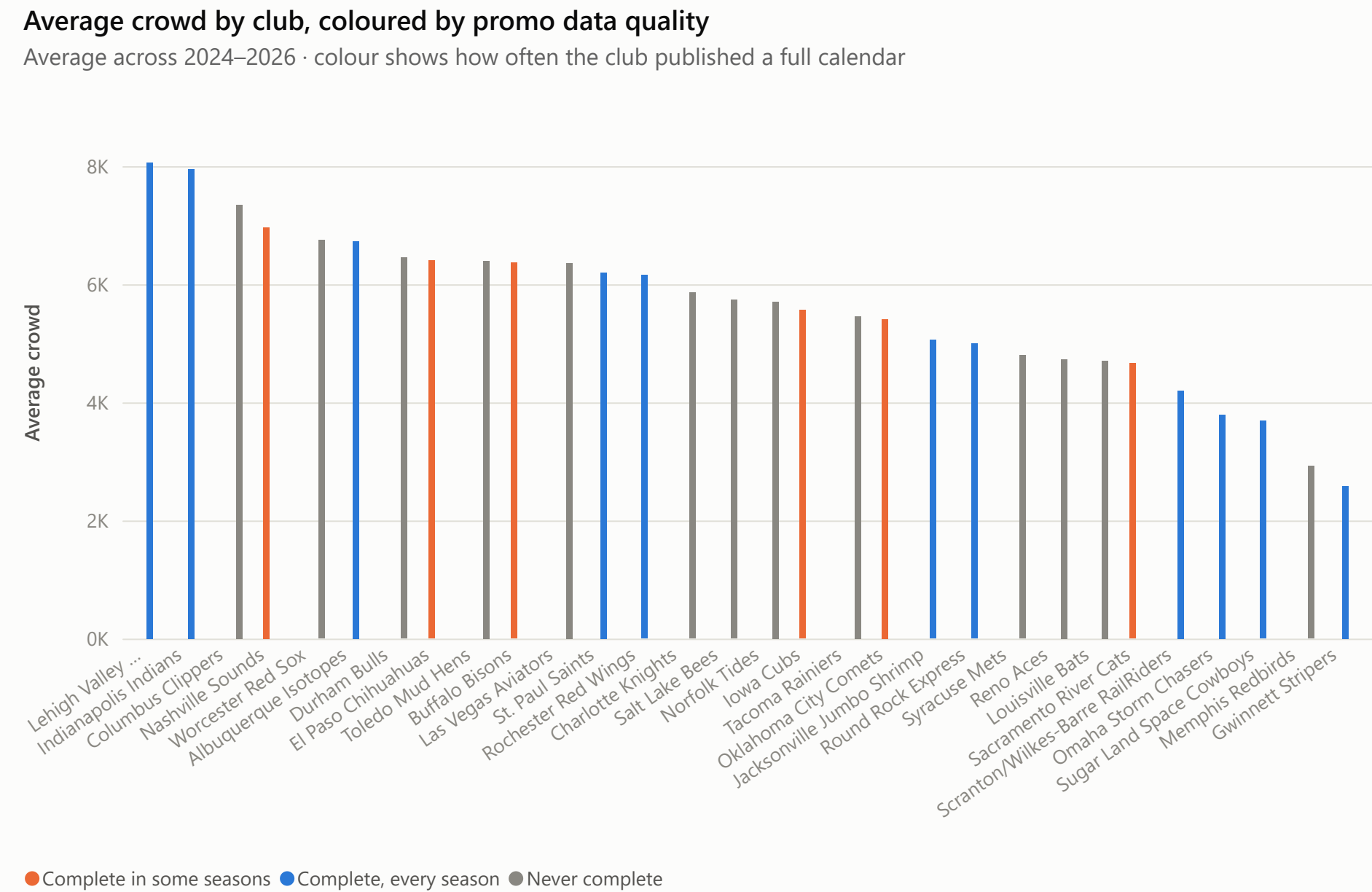
11

Gap, biggest to smallest club (×)

3.12

Average crowd range

2,585 – 8,063



Club detail

Club	League	Home Dates	Avg Crowd	Giveaways	Promo Data	Seasons with full calendar
Buffalo Bisons	International League	198	6,365.00	27	Complete in some seasons	2
Charlotte Knights	International League	208	5,858.00	10	Never complete	0
Columbus Clippers	International League	198	7,345.00	2	Never complete	0
Durham Bulls	International League	216	6,450.00	1	Never complete	0
Gwinnett Stripers	International League	202	2,585.00	33	Complete, every season	3
Indianapolis Indians	International League	209	7,953.00	30	Complete, every season	3
Iowa Cubs	International League	208	5,562.00	4	Complete in some seasons	2
Jacksonville Jumbo Shrimp	International League	210	5,059.00	48	Complete, every season	3
Lehigh Valley IronPigs	International League	208	8,063.00	86	Complete, every season	3
Louisville Bats	International League	207	4,705.00	2	Never complete	0
Memphis Redbirds	International League	204	2,921.00	12	Never complete	0
Nashville Sounds	International League	202	6,962.00	69	Complete in some seasons	2
Norfolk Tides	International League	192	5,709.00	0	Never complete	0
Omaha Storm Chasers	International League	205	3,796.00	23	Complete, every season	3

League

☐ International League

☐ Pacific Coast League

Promotional calendar

☐ Complete in some seasons

☐ Complete, every season

☐ Never complete

- Average crowds range from 2,585 (Gwinnett) to 8,063 (Lehigh Valley) — a 3.1x spread across three seasons. Club identity is the single largest driver of attendance, which is why the model carries club fixed effects, and season fixed effects on top of them.
- Coverage is graded per club-season, not per club: 11 clubs published a full calendar in every season, 6 in some, and 13 in none. Headline results use the 44 eligible club-seasons.